

f Whome God directed vpon to assure them that he wolde giue their worke good successe.

g This is the twelfth moneth, and conteineth parte of Februarie and parte of Marche. h And the two and fortieth alter their first iurawe.

Nomb. 3. 6. 6. 1. 2.

i Which were of the heathen and forsaken their idolatrie to worship the true God. k Meaning, Darius who was King of Medes, Persians and Assyrians. l Ezr. 10. 18. 19. 20. 21. 22. 23. 24. 25. 26. 27. 28. 29. 30. 31. 32. 33. 34. 35. 36. 37. 38. 39. 40. 41. 42. 43. 44. 45. 46. 47. 48. 49. 50. 51. 52. 53. 54. 55. 56. 57. 58. 59. 60. 61. 62. 63. 64. 65. 66. 67. 68. 69. 70. 71. 72. 73. 74. 75. 76. 77. 78. 79. 80. 81. 82. 83. 84. 85. 86. 87. 88. 89. 90. 91. 92. 93. 94. 95. 96. 97. 98. 99. 100.

a The Ebrewes write, that diuers of the Kings of Persia were called by this name, as Pharaoh was a comūne name to the Kings of Egypt, and Cesar to the Emperours of Rome. b Ezrā deduced his kinred, til he cometh to Aaron, to proue that he came of him. c He sheweth here what a scribe is, who had charge to write the Law & to expound it, whome Marke calleth a scribe. Mar. 12. 28. Mat and Luke call him a lawyer, or doctor of the Law. Mar. 12. 34. Luk. 10. 25.

f Haggái the Prophet, and Zechariáh the sonne of Iddó, and they buylded and finished it, by the appointemēt of the God of Israél, and by the commandement of Cyrus and Darius, & Artahſhaſhte King of Persia.

15 And this house was finished the third day of the moneth g Adar, which was h the sixt yere of y reigne of King Darius.

16 ¶ And the children of Israél, the Priests, & the Leuites, and the residue of the children of the captiuitie kept the dedicacion of this house of God with ioye,

17 And offered at the dedicaciō of this house of God an hundreth bullockes, two hundreth rams, fourc hundreth lambes & twelue goates, for the sinne of all Israél, according to the number of the tribes of Israél.

18 And they set the Priests in their ordre, and the Leuites in their courses ouer the seruice of God in Ierusalém, as it is written in the i booke of Mosés.

19 And the children of the captiuitie kept the Pasſeouer on the fourtente day of the first moneth.

20 (For the Priests & the Leuites were purified all together) & they killed the Pasſeouer for all the children of the captiuitie, & for their brethren the Priests, & for them selues.

21 So the children of Israél which were come againe out of captiuitie, and all suche as had i separated them selues vnto them, from the filthines of the heathen of the lād, to seke y Lord God of Israél, did eat,

22 And they kept the feast of vnleauened bread seuen dayes with ioye: for the Lord had made them glad, and turned the heart of the King of k Asshúr vnto them, to i encourage them in the worke of the house of God, euen the God of Israél.

CHAP. VII.

¶ By the commādemēt of the King, Ezrá and his companions come to Ierusalém. 27 He giueth thākes to God.

NOW after these things, in the reigne of a Artahſhaſhte King of Persia, was Ezrá the sonne of Seraiáh, the sonne of Azariáh, the sonne of Hilkiáh,

2 The sonne of Shallúm, the sonne of Zádók, the sonne of Ahitúb,

3 The sonne of Amariáh, the sonne of Azariáh, the sonne of Meraióth,

4 The sonne of Zeraiáh, the sonne of Vz-zí, the sonne of Bukkí,

5 The sonne of Abissúa, the sonne of Phin-chás, the sonne of Eleazár, the sonne of Aaron, the chief Priest.

6 This Ezrá came vp from Babél, and was a c scribe prompt in the Law of Mosés, which the Lord God of Israél had giuen, and the King gaue him all his request according to the hand of the Lord his

God which was vpon him.

7 And there went vp certeine of the children of Israél, and of the Priests, and the Leuites, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims vnto Ierusalém, in the seuent yere of King Artahſhaſhte.

8 And he came to Ierusalém in the d fift moneth, which was in the seuent yere e of the King.

9 For vpon the first day of the first moneth began he to go vp from Babél, and on the first day of the fift moneth came he to Ierusalém, according to the good hand of his God that was vpon him.

10 For Ezrá had prepared his heart to seke the Law of the Lord, and to do it, & to teache the precepts & iudgements in Israél.

11 ¶ And this is the copie of the letter that King Artahſhaſhte gaue vnto Ezrá the Priest & scribe, eue a writer of the wordes of the cōmandements of the Lord, and of his statutes ouer Israél.

12 ARTAHSHASHTE King of Kings to Ezrá y Priest & perfite scribe of the Law of the God of heauen, and to f Cheéneth.

13 I haue giuen cōmandement, that euerie one, that is willing in my kingdome of the people of Israél, and of the Priests, and Leuites s to go to Ierusalém with thee, shal go.

14 Therefore art thou sent of the King and his seuen counselors, to h enquire in Iudáh and Ierusalém, according to the Law of thy God, which is in i thine hand,

15 And to carie the siluer and the golde, w the King and his couēlers willingly offer vnto the God of Israél (whose habitation is in Ierusalém)

16 And all the siluer and golde that thou canst finde in all the prouince of Babél, with the fre offering of the people, and that which the Priests offre willingly to y house of their God which is in Ierusalém,

17 That thou maiest bye spedely with this siluer, bullockes, rams, lambes, with their meat offerings and their drinke offerings: & thou shalt offer the vpon the alrar of the house of your God, which is in Ierusalém.

18 And whatsoeuer it pleaseth thee & thy brethrē to do with the rest of the siluer, and golde, do ye it according to the wil of your k God.

19 And the vessels that are giuen thee for the seruice of the house of thy God, those deliuer thou before God in Ierusalém.

20 And the residue that shalbe nedeful for the house of thy God, which shalbe mete for thee to bestowe, thou shalt bestowe it out of the Kings treasure house,

21 And I King Artahſhaſhte haue gi- uen commandement to all the treasures which are beyonde l the Riuer, that whatsoeuer Ezrá the Priest and scribe

d That contained parte of Iulie and parte of August. e Of King Darius.

f Some take this for the name of a people, some for time or continuance, meaning y the King wished him long life.

g Which remained as yet in Babylon, & had not returned with Zerubbabél.

h To examine who liued according to the Law.

i Whereof thou art expert.

k As ye know best may serue to Gods glorie.

l Which was the Riuer Euphrates, and they were beyonde it in respect of Babylon.